

Decoding the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly Election

A DATA-ONLY SHOW

A presentation for AtliQ Media
Codebasics Resume Project Challenge

Aditya Dixit

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BREAKING DOWN A NEW PARTY'S PERFORMANCE IN TAMIL NADU 2026 STATE ELECTIONS

- **WHAT?** – A two year old party gained the highest vote share and got the first place in most of the 234 total seats
- **WHY?** – For the Nation's democratic health, it is important to analyse the performance of a new party against the legacies
- **HOW?** – We will dissect the results and associated data that was all declared by the Election Commission of India using the questions suggested by Codebasics dossier

EXPECTATIONS

- **Breakdown of 3 Questions from Codebasics dossier**
- **A top-down approach of scale to dissect the numbers in each Question**
- **A game with numbers – no speculation, no reasons for the data itself and no predictions for the next election cycle.**
- **The base data will be sourced from the Codebasics provided data set and Election Commission of India.**

THREE QUESTIONS ONE STORY

- **The vote share story – As compared to the 2021, how the 2026 vote share in the state changed? Who gained the most votes? Who lost them? Which Constituency**
- **The flip game – Which constituency chose a different party in 2026 vs. 2021? Which constituency retained the party? What do the numbers say? How does it look when plotted on a Sankey Chart?**
- **The margin of victory story – How does the average margin of victory changed from 2021 to 2026? How many victories in 2026 election were a close calls, a strong one or a dominant one?**

SOME BASE NUMBERS

2021

234 Constituencies

3859 Candidates

109 Parties

Registered Voters +62M

Voter turnout 72.73%

Votes Casted +46M

2026

234 Constituencies

3992 Candidates

105 Parties

Registered Voters +57M

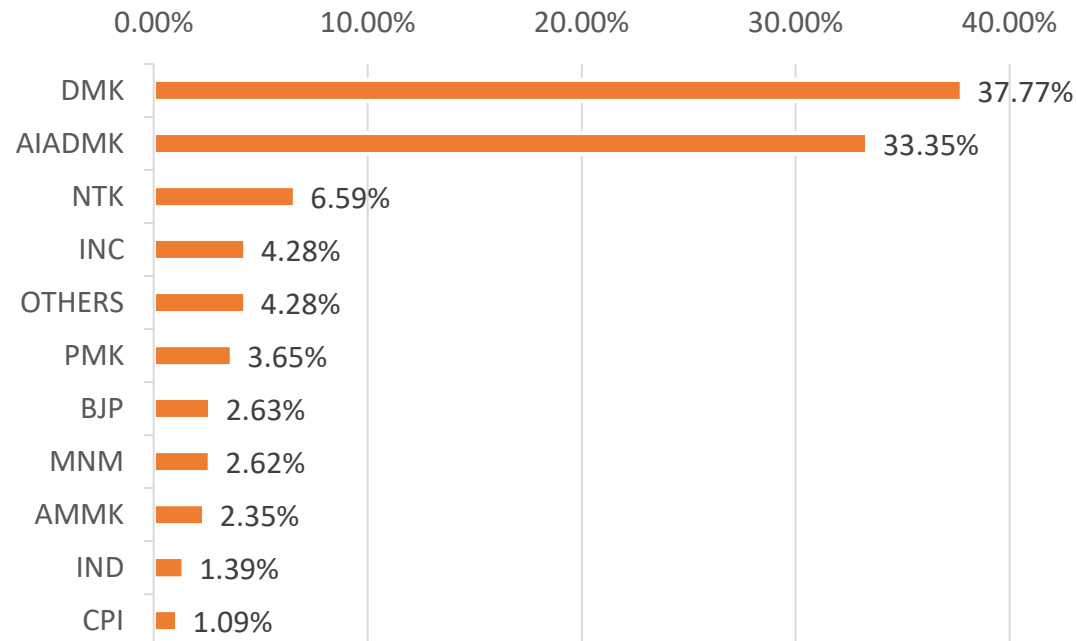
Voter turnout 85.14%

Votes Casted +49M

THE VOTE SHARE STORY

2021

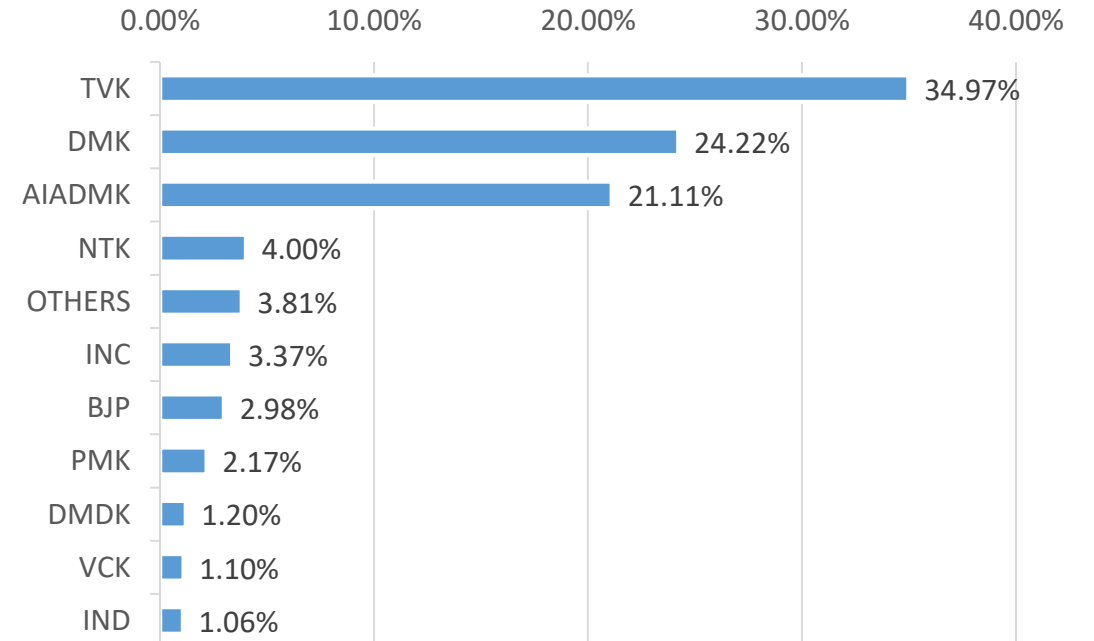
Vote Share by Party



Top 10 Parties captured +94% votes on State level

2026

Vote Share by Party

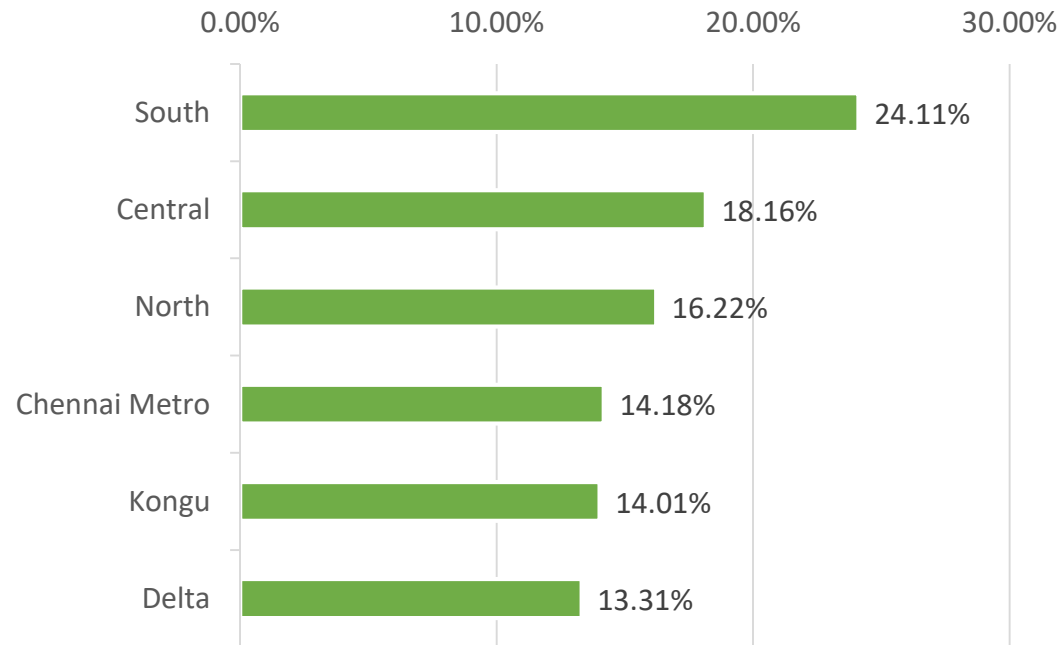


Top 10 Parties captured +96% votes on State level

THE VOTE SHARE STORY

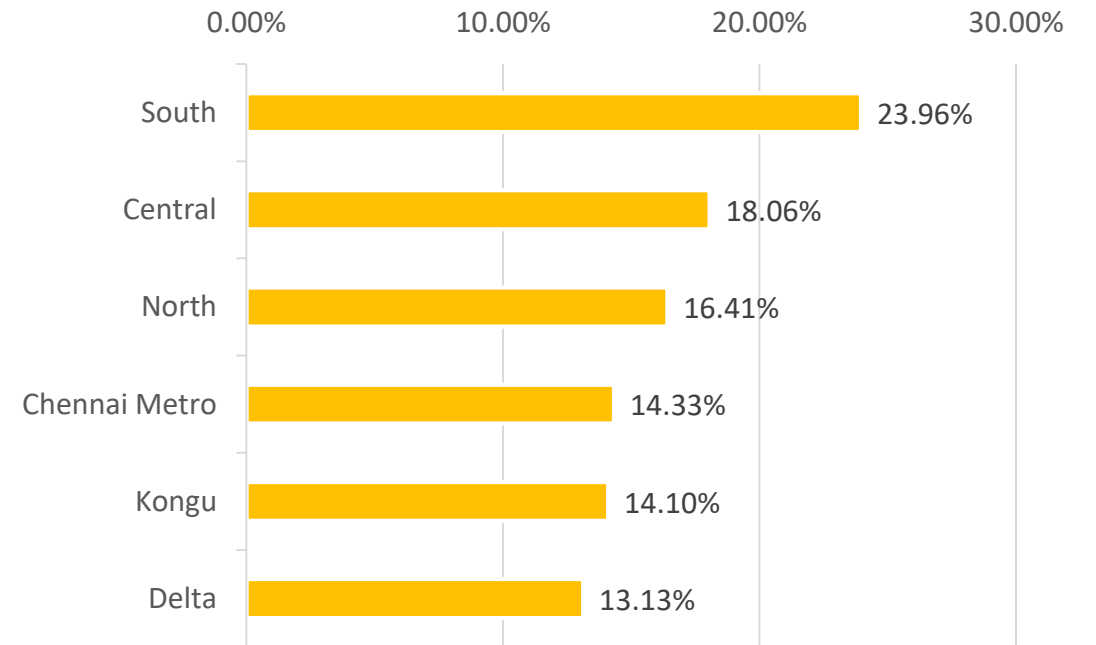
2021

Vote Share by Region



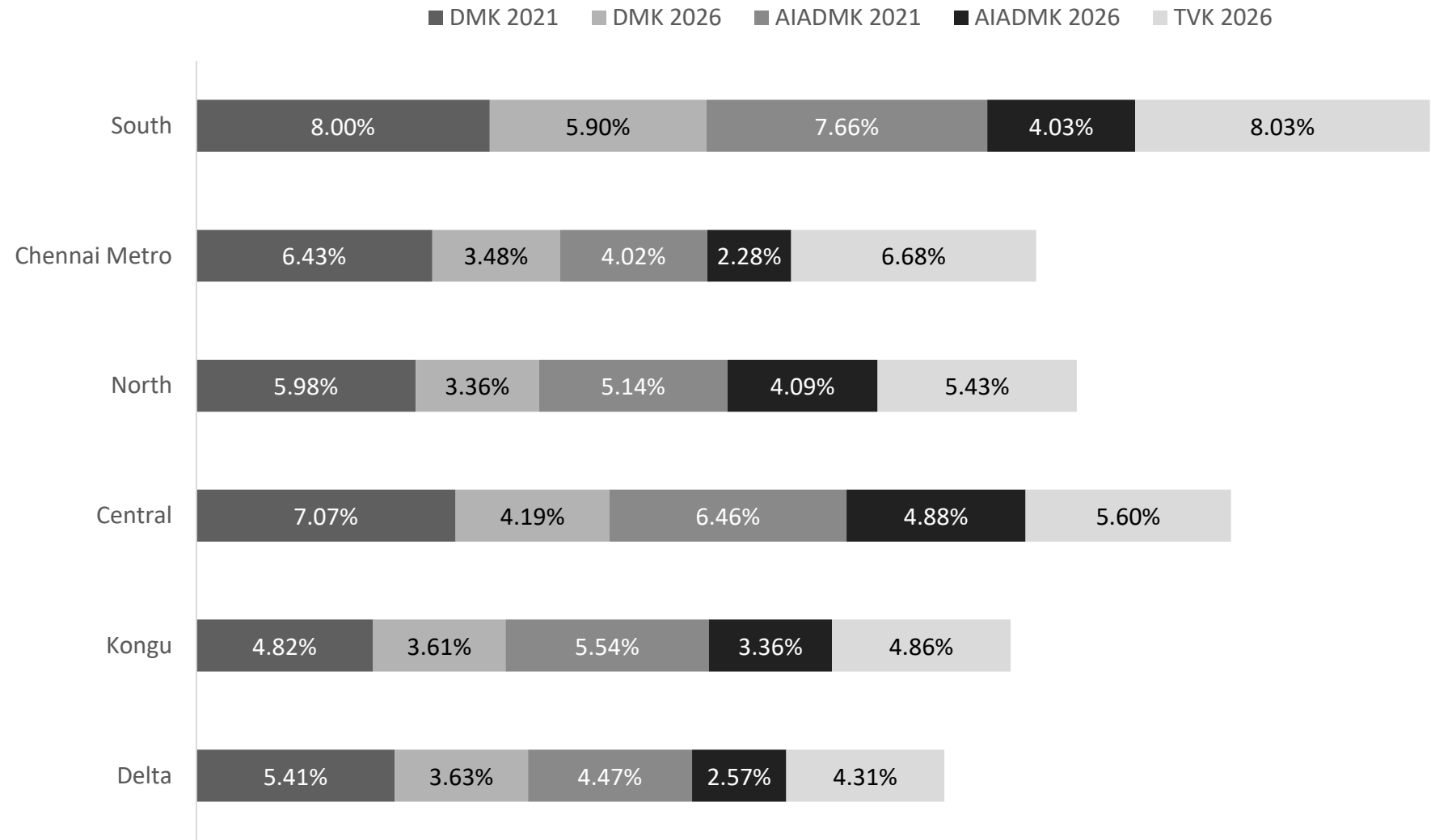
2026

Vote Share by Region



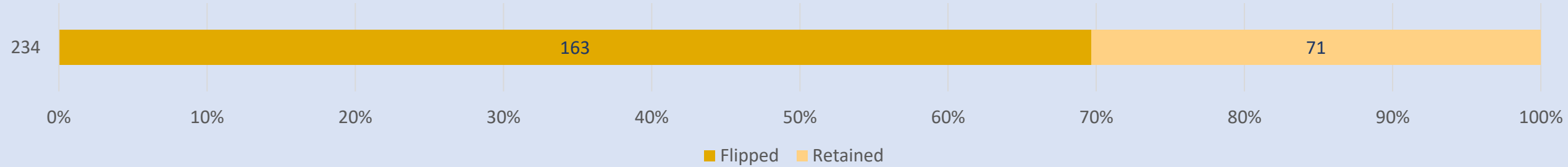
THE VOTE SHARE STORY

Regional Vote Share

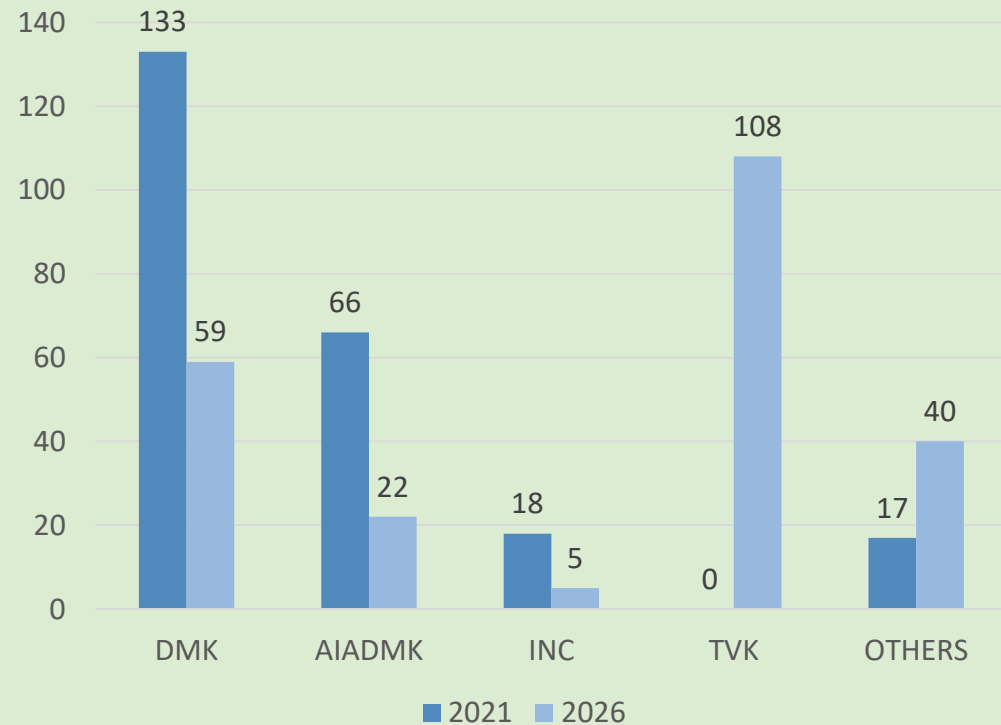


THE FLIP GAME

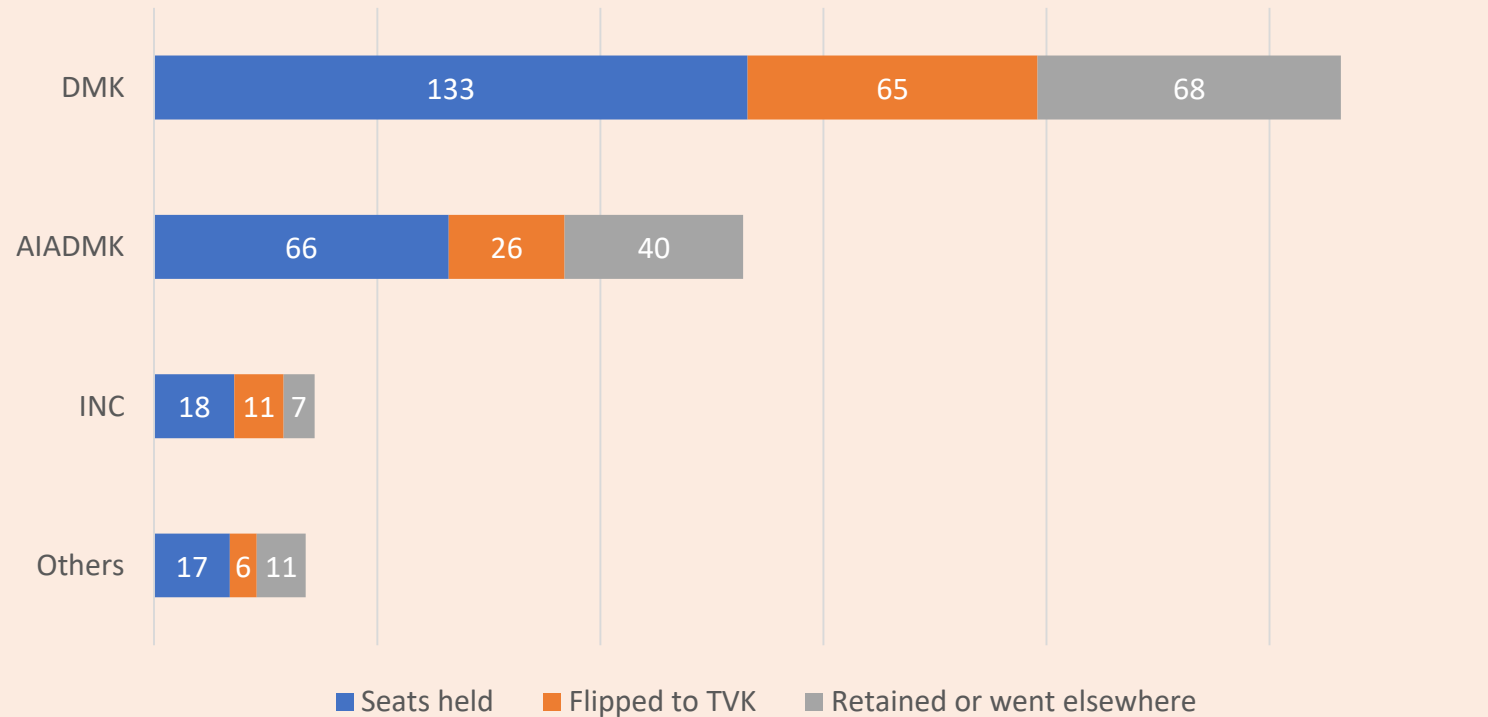
Flipped Seats vs. Retained Seats



Seats Distribution 2021 vs. 2026

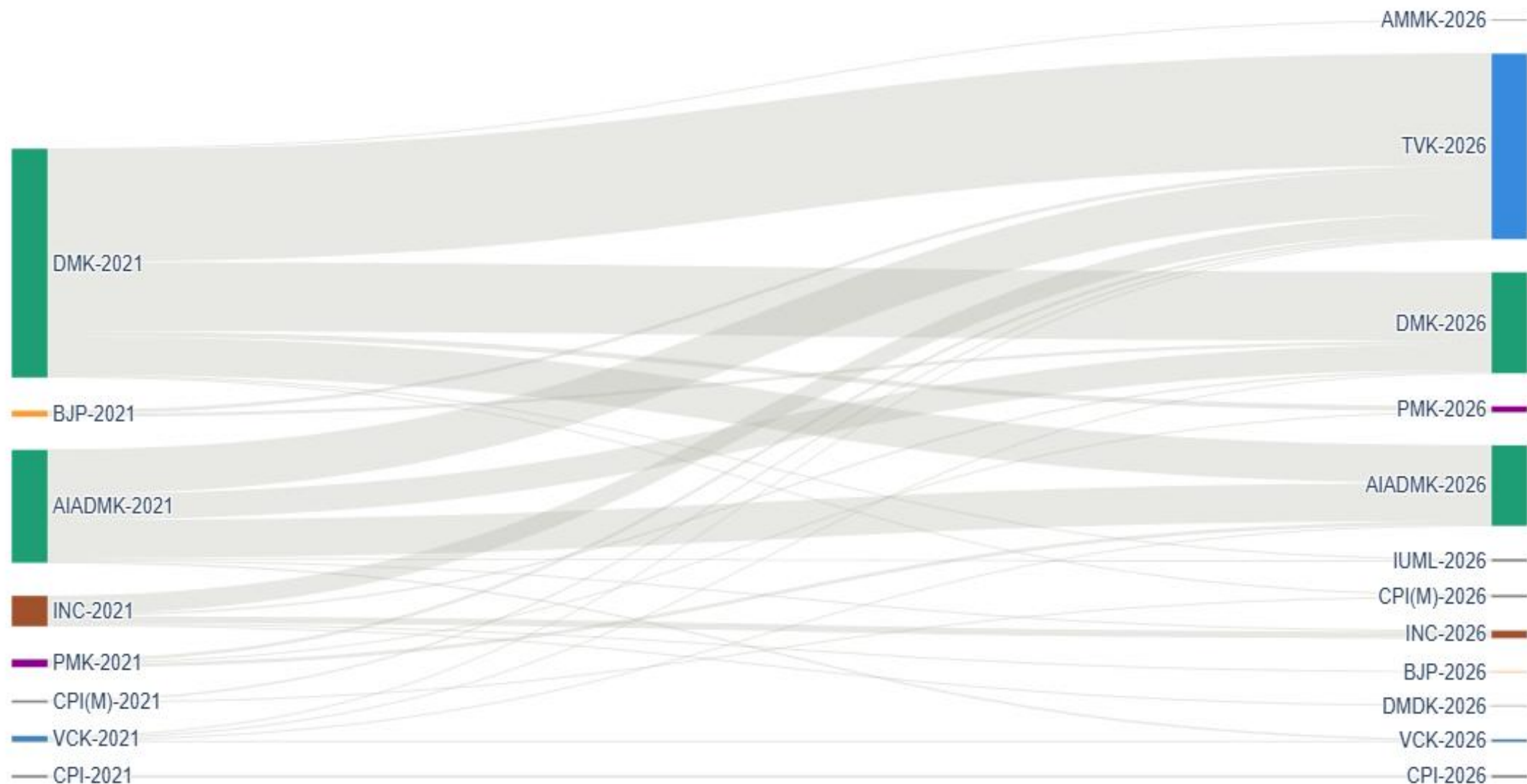


TVK Seats vs. Legacy Party Flipped Seats



THE FLIP GAME

Sankey Chart visualizing the Seat Flip from 2021 to 2026



THE MARGIN OF VICTORY STORY

$$\text{Margin of Victory \%} = \frac{100 \times (\text{Winner votes} - \text{Runner-up votes})}{(\text{Total valid votes})}$$

2026 Worked example
Gummidipoondi constituency no. 1:

15 Candidates + NOTA

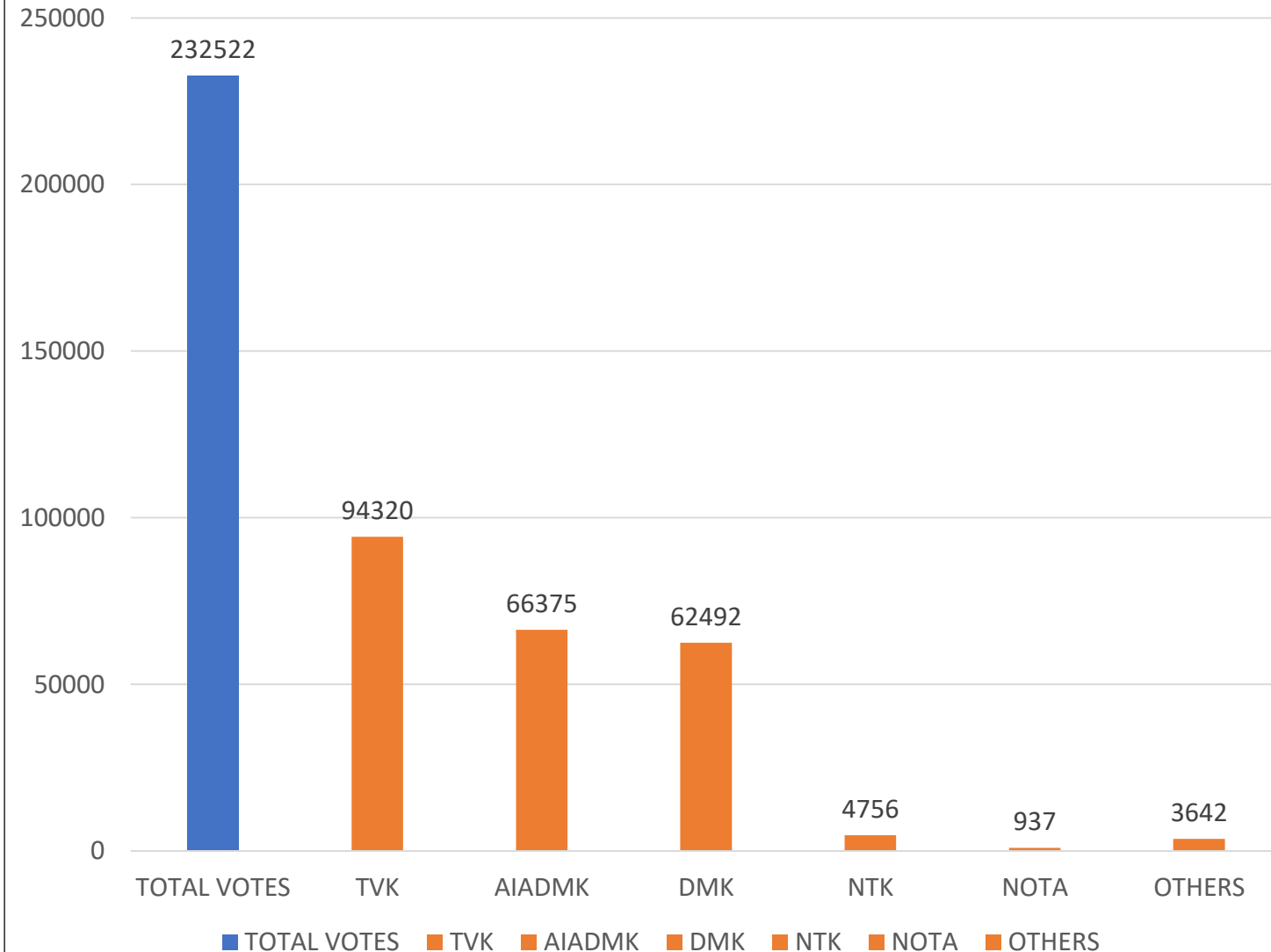
Total valid votes — 232,522

First — TVK — 94,320 votes

Runner up — AIADMK — 66,375 votes

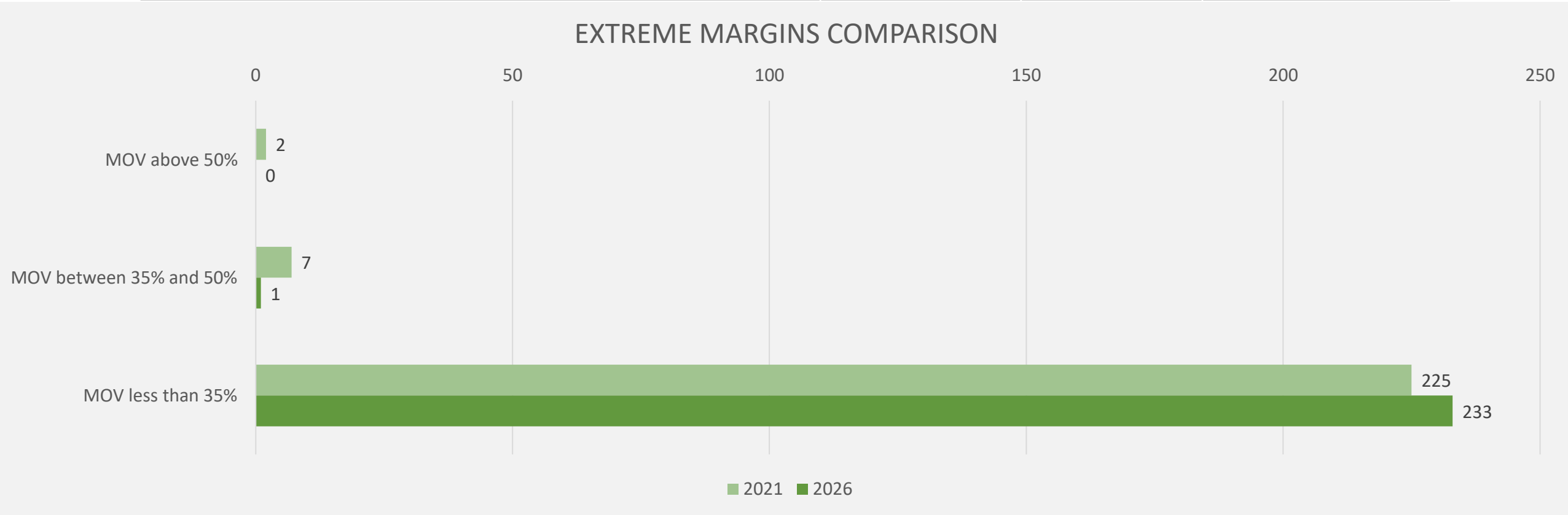
$$\text{Margin of Victory \%} = \frac{100 \times (94,320 - 66,375)}{232,522} = 12.02\%$$

2026 – Votes Distribution – Gummidipoondi



THE MARGIN OF VICTORY STORY

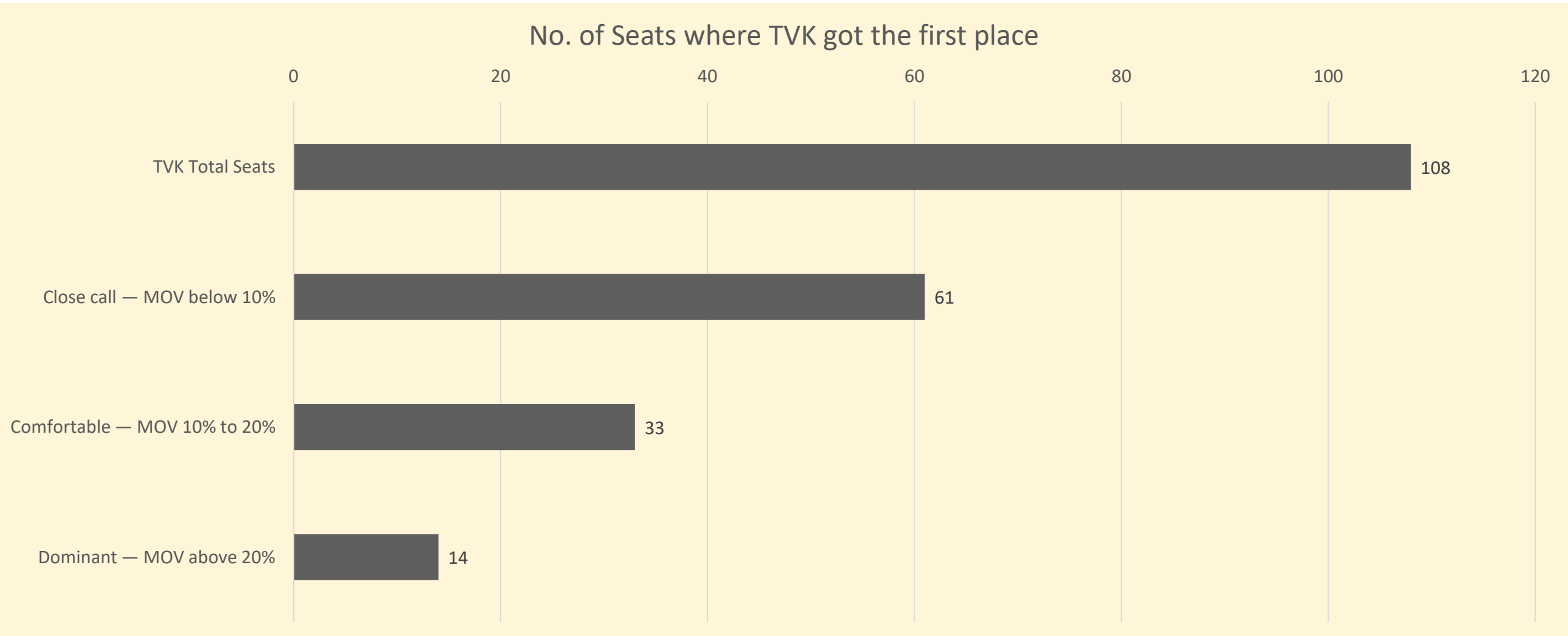
Metric	2021	2026	Change
Average MOV across all 234 constituencies	11.70%	7.67%	-4.03 points



Notable facts – In 2021, two constituencies (19 & 129) returned margins above 50%. In 2026, none did.
- Constituency No. 86 had a strong AIADMK margin in both 2021 (37.93%) and 2026 (37.99%). The only consistent stronghold across both elections in this metric.

THE MARGIN OF VICTORY STORY

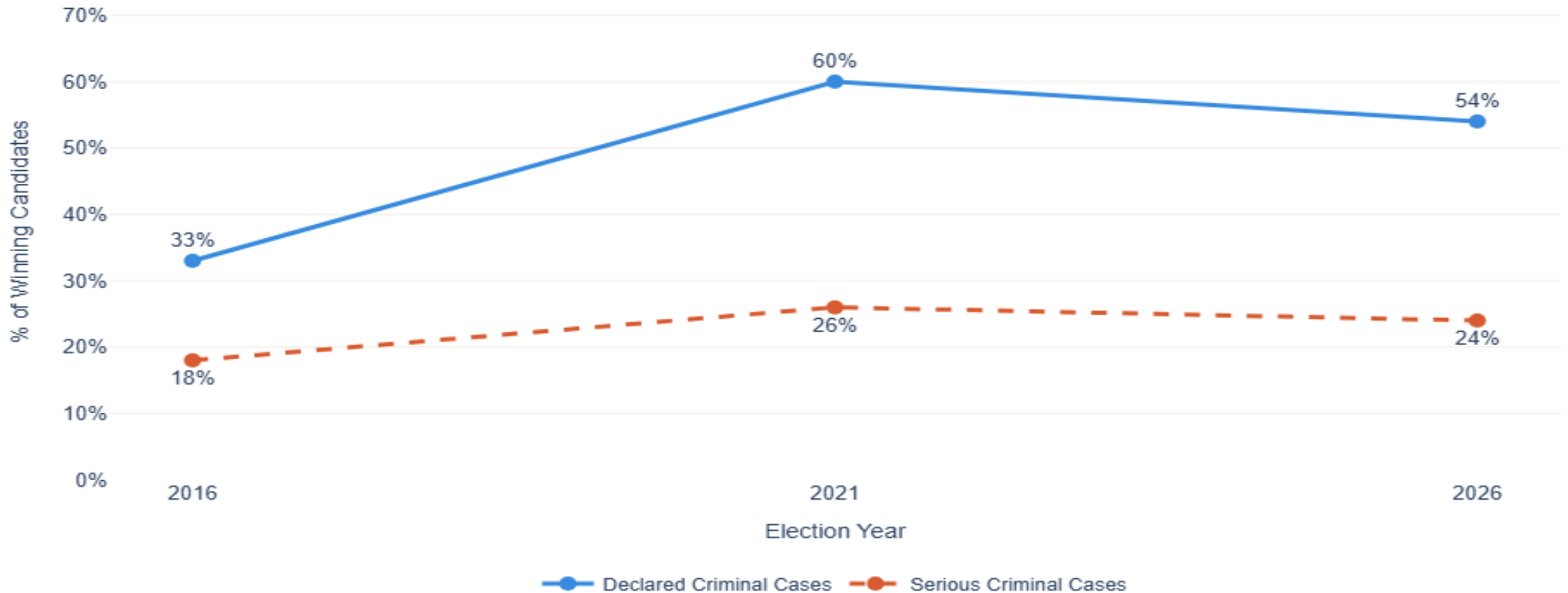
What was TVK's performance with respect to the Margin of Victory Story?



BONUS – THE CRIMINAL STORY

Winning Candidates with Declared Criminal Cases

Source: ADR/myneta.info — self-declared ECI affidavit data



LIMITATIONS

Section	Keep
Analytical	Causality cannot be established from results data alone – Why the votes shifted? Which political or social topics were the driving force for the result?
Analytical	Turnout increase from 2021 to 2026 means some 2026 votes came from new voters — exact party split unknown
Analytical	Candidate party switching not detectable from ECI results data – Party switching is not considered for the analysis, so if the winning candidates in 2021 changed their parties in 2026 and still won, that cannot be determined
Analytical	Regional groupings are editorial convention, not official ECI classification
Analytical	MOV trend uses two years only — not sufficient to establish long term pattern 2021 & 2026 – only set a comparison for election cycles
Scope	Three questions only — Q3, Q2, Q6 – from the Codebasics dossier
Scope	No demographic breakdown possible from ECI data – which was prohibited in the rules
Scope	No exit polls, news articles, or opinion data used – prohibited by the rules

DATA SOURCES

- Codebasics RPC Starter Dataset tn_2021_results.csv · tn_2026_results.csv · constituency_master.csv Cleaned from ECI and Trivedi Centre for Political Data, Ashoka University
- Candidate Affidavit Data myneta.info — Association for Democratic Reforms Original source: ECI affidavit archive — <https://affidavit.eci.gov.in/>

DECLARATION

To the best of my knowledge and intent, this analysis is non-partisan. I have not taken any position in favour of or against any party, leader, alliance, community, or electoral outcome. Every observation in this presentation describes data only. All sources are publicly available and ECI-verified. No exit polls, news articles, opinion polls, or social media data were used at any stage of this analysis.